

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- The Stop School Cuts coalition (ASCL, NEU, NAHT) says schools have lost £4.5bn to real-terms funding cuts since 2010, with 92% of secondaries left worse off.
→ **For your school:** *Union-commissioned figures, not independent stats — useful context if you're building a funding case, but cite with that caveat.*
- DfE's consultation on reforming education otherwise than at school (EOTAS) for children with EHC plans closes 18 September.
→ **For your school:** *Get any school or trust response in before the deadline.*

DATES FOR THE DIARY

18 Sep 2026 — DfE EOTAS (education otherwise than at school) consultation closes.

18 Sep 2026 — Rotherham Schools Forum meets — agenda includes the exclusion & suspensions annual report and an EHCP update.

FUNDING

- **Unions: schools £4.5bn worse off since 2010.** The Stop School Cuts coalition's report, launched this week, puts real-terms losses at £4.5bn over 16 years, with over 3,700 schools down more than £1,000 per pupil and 92% of secondaries worse off than in 2010. ([Schools Week](#))
→ **For your school:** *Treat the topline figures as a campaign framing rather than official statistics.*

INCLUSION & SEND

- **EOTAS consultation deadline approaching.** The government's proposals on education otherwise than at school for pupils with EHC plans close for responses on 18 September, feeding into a planned Education for All Bill; existing EHCPs stay protected until 2030. ([GOV.UK](#))

SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

- **Rotherham forum to review exclusions and EHCPs.** Rotherham's Schools Forum meets 18 September to consider its exclusion & suspensions annual report, an EHCP update and 2027/28 budget planning — a useful read-across given Sheffield's own high-needs budget pressures. ([Rotherham MBC](#))

JARGON-BUSTER - EOTAS

Cropping up in this month's SEND consultation:

Education Otherwise Than at School — when a council arranges a child's EHC-plan provision somewhere other than a school or college, e.g. at home or via a mixed package of providers.

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.